

Rydeshare

AI Project Manager — Operator's Manual

Commercial-plumbing tenant-improvement (TI) · NorCal union crews

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Rydeshare is a terminal chat app that acts as your project manager's brain. You tell it about a plumbing TI job; it builds the plan, tracks every stage, tells you the single next action, and asks you for whatever it's missing. The money math (labor, wages, bid) is done by deterministic, unit-tested code — not guessed by the AI — so the numbers are reproducible. Everything is stored as plain JSON files on your machine.

COMPLIANCE — READ THIS. Every wage rate shipped with the tool is an unverified placeholder. Confirm against the current CA DIR determination (dir.ca.gov/oprl) and the applicable UA-local CBA before any bid, payroll, or contract use. This tool assists a qualified PM — it does not replace certified-payroll review, apprentice-ratio compliance, or licensed/code judgment.

Getting started

1. One-time setup

You need Node.js 22 or newer and an Anthropic API key (console.anthropic.com !' API Keys). The key lives only in your local .env file, which is gitignored and never committed.

```
cp .env.example .env      # paste your ANTHROPIC_API_KEY into .env
npm install
```

2. See it work in 60 seconds (no API key)

Before you wire up a key, watch the whole job play out. It drives the real engine and writes to a throwaway temp dir, so your real jobs are never touched.

```
npm run demo              # press Enter to step through each stage
npm run demo -- --auto    # hands-off – plays straight through
```

3. Start the app for real

```
npm run dev              # starts the chat REPL; type a message or a /command
```

Quit any time with /exit (or Ctrl-C).

Two ways to drive it

Slash commands are shortcuts; you can also just talk in plain English and the brain picks the right tool.

- /new "<name>" region=<SF|East Bay|North Bay|Sacramento|San Jose> — create a job
- /open <projectId> — reopen a saved job and get its next action
- /ingest <path-to-xlsx> — import a FastPipe export into the active job
- /status or /next — show the deterministic NEXT ACTION + OPEN QUESTIONS
- /projects — list saved jobs · /help — banner · /exit — quit

The job lifecycle (stages)

A job moves through these stages. The tool will not let you skip ahead while required info is still missing — answer the open questions and it advances.

- Lease / Scope Review !' Estimate & Takeoff (FastPipe) !' Bid / Proposal
- Contract / Buyout !' Submittals & RFIs !' Schedule & Manpower
- Procurement !' Install & Inspections !' Certified Payroll
- Change Orders !' Closeout

Wages — the part that matters most

- Wages are seeded per UA local (38, 342, 393, 447) and every rate is flagged verify=true — do not trust the number yet.

- To confirm a rate, just tell the brain: "Confirmed journeyman base is \$95/hr per the Local 342 CBA." That clears the flag and records who/when.
- Any bid computed while unverified rates are in play is stamped UNVERIFIED — your guardrail against sending a number to a customer too early.

Troubleshooting

- WARNING: ANTHROPIC_API_KEY is not set !' copy .env.example to .env and paste your key.
- Unknown region "..." !' use exactly: SF, East Bay, North Bay, Sacramento, or San Jose.
- Won't advance a stage !' there are still OPEN QUESTIONS; run /status and answer them.
- A bid still says UNVERIFIED !' at least one wage rate is still a placeholder.
- Node version error !' you need Node 22+ (check with node --version).

The guided demo, step by step

These are live screenshots captured from `npm run demo -- --auto`. Every number is produced by the real engine — no API key, throwaway data dir.

Step 1 — Create the job

```
% STEP 1/8 – Create the job

Pick a region; it resolves the UA local and seeds placeholder wages.
cmd > /new "Acme Tower 12th-floor TI" region=East Bay
!' Created. UA Loca342 (East Bay), wage table seeded (all unverified).

[Acme Tower 12th-floor TI · Lease / Scope Review]
NEXT ACTION: Lease / Scope Review: Confirm the job basics: client/GC, region (drives the UA
local), jurisdiction, whether this is public works, and a scope summary. (resolve the blocking
items below to proceed)
OPEN QUESTIONS:
  • Is this a public works job (> $1,000 of public funds)? If so, prevailing wage + weekly
  certified payroll + apprentice ratios apply.
```

Step 2 — Ask what it needs

```
% STEP 2/8 – Ask what it needs

The NEXT ACTION + OPEN QUESTIONS are computed by code, not guessed.
cmd > /status

[Acme Tower 12th-floor TI · Lease / Scope Review]
NEXT ACTION: Lease / Scope Review: Confirm the job basics: client/GC, region (drives the UA
local), jurisdiction, whether this is public works, and a scope summary. (resolve the blocking
items below to proceed)
OPEN QUESTIONS:
  • Is this a public works job (> $1,000 of public funds)? If so, prevailing wage + weekly
  certified payroll + apprentice ratios apply.
  !' It is blocking on the public-works question before it will move on.
```

Step 3 — Import the FastPipe estimate

```
% STEP 3/8 – Import the FastPipe estimate

It parses the export and reports any column it can't map.
cmd > /ingest samples/sample_fastpipe.xlsx
!5 line items · 338.5 labor hrs · $21,420.00 material.
& Unmapped column(s): Notes – confirm or add an alias.
```

Step 4 — Answer in plain English

%¶ STEP 4/8 – Answer in plain English

In the live app you just talk; the brain calls `update_project`.

`you > Public works yes. Crew is 1 foreman, 3 journeymen, 1 step-3 apprentice.`

`!'` Recorded public-works = yes, scope, and the 5-person crew.

Step 5 — Compute labor cost

%¶ STEP 5/8 – Compute labor cost

Estimate hours × blended loaded crew rate – deterministic code.

`you > What's the labor cost?`

`!338.5 hrs × $111.71/hr = $37,813.84`

`& Blend used UNVERIFIED placeholder wages – confirm before quoting.`

Step 6 — Compute the bid

%¶ STEP 6/8 – Compute the bid

Full waterfall with overhead & profit. Every input is echoed back.

`you > Use 15% overhead and 10% profit. Compute the bid.`

`% % Bid waterfall % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % %`

`%Labor (loaded) $37,813.84`

`%Labor + burden $37,813.84`

`%Material $21,420.00`

`%Tax $1,765.00`

`%Rentals $500.00`

`%Subtotal $61,498.84`

`%Contingency $0.00`

`%Overhead $9,224.83`

`%Profit $7,072.37`

`% % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % %`

`%TOTAL BID $77,796.04`

`% % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % %`

`& Labor uses UNVERIFIED placeholder wage rates (verify=true) – confirm against the current DIR determination / UA-local CBA before quoting.`

`!'` The UNVERIFIED stamp is your guardrail: don't send this number to a customer yet.

Step 7 — Confirm a CBA wage & re-run

%¶ STEP 7/8 – Confirm a CBA wage & re-run

```
you > Confirmed journeyman base is $95/hr per the Local 342 CBA. Re-run the bid.
```

%Labor (loaded)	\$40,860.34
-----------------	-------------

%Labor + burden	\$40,860.34
-----------------	-------------

%Material	\$21,420.00
-----------	-------------

%Tax	\$1,765.00
------	------------

%Rentals	\$500.00
----------	----------

%Subtotal	\$64,545.34
-----------	-------------

%Contingency	\$0.00
--------------	--------

%Overhead	\$9,681.80
-----------	------------

%Profit	\$7,422.71
---------	------------

%TOTAL BID	\$81,649.85
-------------------	--------------------

& Labor uses UNVERIFIED placeholder wage rates (verify=true) – confirm against the current DIR determination / UA-local CBA before quoting.

```
' Journeyman row verifiedBid moved $77,796.04 ! $81,649.85.
```

Step 8 — Advance the stage

%¶ STEP 8/8 – Advance the stage

you › Looks good – move us to the next stage.

' Advanced.

[Acme Tower 12th-floor TI · Estimate & Takeoff (FastPipe)]

```

    NEXT ACTION: Estimate & Takeoff (FastPipe) is unblocked – confirm with the user, then
advance_stage to "Bid / Proposal".

```

That's the loop. ingest !' plan !' ask !' compute !' verify !' advance.

Run it for real with your own jobs: **npm run dev**

Full guide: [MANUAL.md](#)

That's the loop: ingest !' plan !' ask !' compute !' verify !' advance. Run it for real with your own jobs via `npm run dev`. The editable source of this manual is `MANUAL.md` in the repo.